validore

Startup validation report

A reusable Validore planning template

Version 1.0 | [Report date]

Executive decision

Use this report to decide what to test, change, or build next. Replace the bracketed prompts, retain the evidence labels, and connect important claims to original sources.

Business and founder [Business name] / [Founder or team]

Recommendation [Proceed to a test / Refine the concept / Research further / Stop]

Decision in one paragraph [What the evidence suggests, the main constraint, and the next commitment]

Confidence and evidence limits [Low / Medium / High, with reasons]

Decision scorecard

Scores organize judgment; they do not measure the probability of success. Explain the evidence behind each score.

Problem [/20] Customer [/20] Market [/15]

Competition [/10] Willingness to pay [/15]

Business model [/10] Financial feasibility [/5] Execution [/5]

Total [/100] Main reason for the decision [Explain]

The next commitment

Next action [One measurable experiment or delivery milestone]

Owner and review date [Name] / [Date]

Pass or stop threshold [The result that would change this decision]

Idea and customer

One sentence concept [For whom, which problem, and what useful outcome]

Customer and geography [Specific segment, buyer, user, and location]

Current alternative [How this customer solves the problem today]

Market sizing

Use Not established when source-backed customer counts or spending inputs are missing. All market sizes remain projections.

Total addressable market [Customer count x annual spend] / [Source and year]

Serviceable market [Reachable segment and geographic limits] / [Method]

Initial obtainable market [Delivery capacity and acquisition plan] / [Timeframe]

Customer hypotheses

Problem hypothesis [Frequency, severity, urgency, and current workaround]

Willingness to pay [What is known, what is assumed, and the proposed test]

Customer evidence [Research reference, sample, date, and limitation]

Competitive alternatives

Direct competitor [Product, customer, pricing source, and date checked]

Indirect substitute or partner [Relationship to the same customer job]

Differentiation to test [Specific advantage and the evidence needed]

Product direction

Selected value proposition [Customer outcome, differentiation, and reason to believe]

Smallest useful product [One core workflow that tests the riskiest hypothesis]

Feature priorities [Must have] / [Should have] / [Later] / [Excluded]

Financial assumptions

State one currency and time period. Keep assumptions separate from measured costs and revenue.

Currency and period [Currency] / [Monthly or annual]

Price and variable cost [Selling price] / [Cost per customer or unit]

Fixed costs and acquisition [Monthly fixed costs] / [CAC per new customer]

Customers, churn, and cash [Count] / [Monthly churn] / [Available cash]

Calculated economics

Margin and break even [Contribution margin] / [Customers needed to break even]

Retention and runway [LTV method] / [LTV to CAC] / [Cash runway]

Scenario comparison [Downside, base, and upside inputs and outcomes]

Risks and mitigations

Main risk [Risk] / [Likelihood and impact] / [Early signal] / [Owner]

Critical dependency [Provider, legal, operational, or delivery constraint]

Validation experiments

These are proposed activities. Label outcomes as observed only after the work has been completed and recorded.

Experiment 1 [Hypothesis] / [Method and target customer]

Measurement [Metric] / [Sample and sampling limits] / [Pass or fail threshold]

Execution [Owner] / [Dates] / [Budget] / [Results record]

Experiment 2 [Next hypothesis and the same measurement details]

Weekly action plan

Weeks 1 and 2 [Customer problem test] / [Owner] / [Measurable KPI]

Weeks 3 and 4 [Pricing or product test] / [Owner] / [Measurable KPI]

Weeks 5 and 6 [Channel or delivery test] / [Owner] / [Measurable KPI]

Decision checkpoints

Continue when [Evidence threshold and acceptable cost]

Change direction when [Assumption disproved or constraint reached]

Stop when [Clear stopping condition]

Next review [Date, decision owner, and required evidence]

Evidence register

Give every material claim an original source, date, relevant excerpt, and limitation. Distinguish source interpretation, assumptions, projections, and proposed strategy.

Source 1 [Claim] / [Original URL or research record] / [Publication date]

Assessment [Supports / Contradicts / Inconclusive] / [Relevant excerpt and reason]

Limitations [Geography, customer segment, sample, and retrieval date]

Additional sources [Repeat this structure for each important claim]

Unresolved assumptions

Unknown input or claim [What is missing and why it matters]

Evidence required [How to resolve it] / [Owner] / [Review date]

Research team contributions

Full reports can involve market, customer, competition, finance, risk, source review, product, growth, and lead review specialists. Record the work actually completed.

Completed work [Specialists and useful tool results]

Incomplete work [Missing sections, unavailable sources, or limits reached]

Founder review

Reviewed by [Name and date]

Decision and changes [Next step, corrections, and remaining reservations]

AI research supports a decision. It does not establish demand, certify a source interpretation, or guarantee commercial results.